of the Princes mother and uncle on their way to Mecca has prevented his journey which I am sorry for because if he had gone he would have taken me with him and I might from thence have gone on to the Caspian, only I believe about three or four stages, and I should have seen two things which after such a long absence would have given me much pleasure. A wooded country and (to the sight) a boundless sea.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO HENRY BURGESS] *Tabreez, August 5, 1847*

A few days ago I received Joe Turpin's letter of the *2nd* July written at my Mother's request as she was too unwell to write herself. He tells me that you grieve much about my position. My dear Father this is wrong. My position except from the fact of being in debt, and in pledge for these debts, is by no means a bad one. My creditors now seldom annoy me. I am under no restraint and altho my pay is small, my position with the Prince causes me to be treated with much greater respect and consideration than I was when I was a merchant. I am very seldom hard worked; and I like my work. I am never so happy as when I have finished a hard days work at my translations. My spirits are then as high as a schoolboy just burst out of school. And I am convinced that amongst the happiest people in this world are those who are the hardest worked. The knowledge I am gaining of the people, their customs and habits, produce, revenue and other matters appertaining to the govt of the country, can not fail at some time or other, to turn out to my advantage. Perhaps no Englishman has been placed in such a situation as I am for gaining an intimate acquaintance with the people. I heard it said that in England the most agreeable men in society, and those who from their general knowledge are most likely to get on in politics, are the lawyers. I am here both lawyer and magistrate; before the Prince and my superiors I often act as lawyer, there I have to plead. But with regard to the inhabitants of the villages I have the charge of, I have to judge; sometimes to punish, sometimes to put in force the decisions of the civil courts; I have to make myself acquainted with all sorts of disputes now about the possession of a vineyard or corn lands and then about a broken head or a drove of stolen cattle.

I have yet received no answer from Col Sheil about your application for leave for me to go to England, but I am expecting one by the courier who ought to arrive to day as I wrote to him myself he will I have no doubt answer my letter. Even if the Hadji gives me leave there must be an order to my creditors not to molest me or prevent my going. By the last post a letter arrived in twenty-six days from Manchester. And if it was not for the quarantine at Trebizonde I could get home well in a month. The quarantine is ten days and there are no means of avoiding it. From thence there are steamers once a week to England.

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